# Fremont Dog Plaza Accident Prevention Program

**Overview of the safety program for Fremont Dog Plaza:**

Over the years there have been moments where regular life or the dogs we work with take advantage in the wrong way, those moments typically end with injury or illness:

- It never feels good seeing one of your coworkers ill, injured, or in pain.
- When an injury is caused specifically by a dog, those moments are even worse.
- We have the potential to lose out on a lot of business and opportunity when we have too many accidents, illnesses, or injuries.
- When that happens, L&I insurance premiums will skyrocket, costing the company a lot of money and time.

To avoid such occurrences in the future, we developed the following safety plan.

I expect that everyone who works for Fremont Dog Plaza will read, understand, and follow the plan.

**It must be abundantly clear: these are not recommendations, not suggestions.**

**WORKER SAFETY IS NOT OPTIONAL**

**Worker safety is a mandatory condition of employment. No person will gamble with the physical or financial health and security of another person, animal, and/or the company.**

**Management's Responsibilities:**

- Create a safety and hazard protocol that is easy to understand.
- Supply employees with the required materials to be successful.
- Have a procedure to easily report hazards in the workplace, at any time.
- Train employees to be safe in the workplace and in the field.

**Employees' Responsibilities:**

- Read and understand the Accident Prevention Program, Employe Handbook, and any safety materials provided.
- Always report hazards in the workplace, whatever or whoever, report the concern.
- Do not tamper or disable safety devices. This includes smoke and co2 detectors, cameras, safety gates, locks, and latches.
- Wear the Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) provided and handle the equipment carefully.

**Emergency Preparedness:**

- In case of fire:
    - Use the nearest fire alarm and alert every person at the facility.
    - If it is a small fire with minimal smoke, attempt to use a fire extinguisher. Remove safety, hold directly in front and squeeze trigger

while aiming at the fire. Always remove the dogs before attempting to extinguish any fires.
    - If the fire is too large to manage, evacuate the building and move all dogs outside to the fenced areas away from the flames. Do not, under any circumstances, let dogs out of the fenced area surrounding the facility unless advised to do so by the fire department. Then, call 9-1-1 and wait for assistance.
    - Perform a headcount to assure every person and dog are accounted for, report the people and pets missing to fire personnel immediately. Do not attempt to rescue people and pets if you are not trained to do so.
- In case of earthquake:
    - To best prepare for an Earthquake, always be aware of your surroundings. Do not leave clutter on the floors or shelves. Be aware of the safe places to duck and cover where there will not be any falling objects. Think of where you can hold on to better protect yourself.
    - The first person to confirm shaking during an active scenario will immediately yell “Earthquake!”
    - Every person should then begin to find the nearest safe place to duck and cover.
    - Hold onto any dogs if possible and secure them as best as you are able while holding on yourself.
    - Once the shaking has stopped, and you know you are okay, ask if anyone is injured. In the event a person is injured, check to see if they are stable and if they are, evacuate them. Do not attempt to move people who are severely injured, wait for trained professionals.
    - Move every person and pet to a safe location outside the building within the fenced area. If the fenced area is compromised, begin leashing and removing dogs out onto the street. Attach leashed dogs to any available object that is sturdy enough to hold the weight of the leash before returning to grab more dogs inside.
    - Do not attempt to return inside the building if it shows signs of collapse.
    - If there is an odor of gas, make sure a manager locates or assists in locating the available gas meter to shut it off. If that is not an option, evacuate further than 250 feet from the gas odor and wait for fire personnel.
    - Remember, there could be aftershocks. Be prepared for anything to happen.
    - An earthquake in Seattle will be a significant event, do not expect any immediate responses from 9-1-1 or emergency personnel. They will be inundated with a wave of major phone calls. Please remain patient, and calm, do not make rash decisions that could cause more damage and trauma to yourself or others.

**First Aid:**

- First aid inside the facility is in the bathroom and the employee lounge.
- Every company vehicle will have a fist aid kit provided; this includes dog

walking apparatuses used by employees.
- All dog walkers will be required to have a small first aid kit during their walks.
- Dog/Human CPR training is mandatory for every employee. New employees have up to one year to complete their training after being hired.

**Injuries:**

- For minor injuries, please treat as necessary using the available first aid kit. Note what medical supplies are taken via the logbook within the kit.
- For immediate emergencies call 9-1-1and notify a manager. Stabilize the situation as much as possible until emergency personnel arrive.
- Fill out an Employee Injury/Illness Report and return it to a manager. If you feel your report was not processed, contact the owner immediately.
- A safety manager will process all the reports received and send the information to the appropriate jurisdictions.
- Cataloging information and keeping it on file is the only way to properly track workplace related safety. This info helps us to avoid repeat incidences in the future.
- Always refer to the handbook for detailed procedures.

**Workplace Safety Reporting and Harm Reduction:**

- Employees, at any time, are allowed to fill out the Employee Workplace Safety and Harm Reduction Report sheets provided. We always respect employee feedback on workplace safety and will always attempt to listen to any concerns.
- In the event of a near miss or close call, fill out the Employee Workplace Safety and Harm Reduction Report to catalog the unsafe work incident and how we can all do better to fix the problem.
- Always hold your coworkers accountable for their mishaps. Do so in a way that shows forgiveness and a strong preservation toward group comradery and perseverance.
- Reports must be filled out and turned into the office on the day of the event. Please do not wait to report workplace related safety events.

**Workplace Chemicals and Cleaners:**

- Always wear PPE while working with chemicals and cleaning agents. Refer to the employee handbook for detailed procedure on when and where to use PPE.
- Do not allow dogs to contact chemicals and cleaning agents.
- Always lock the cabinet that houses chemical and cleaning agents to ensure pet safety.

**Employee Safety Orientation and Training:**

- Before working, all employees must finish an employee training quiz as well as read and sign the Accident Prevention Program.
- Employees, with manager assistance, will tour and learn the layout of the facility to ensure their safety. This includes learning about different locks, latches, gates, and safety related to them.
- Employees who drive company vehicles or perform company-related tasks in their personal vehicle will have an initial driving trial period that will be supervised by a manager. Yearly re-evaluation will be required to ensure overall road and vehicle safety for the drivers and business.
- Regardless of any prior experience, new employees must wait to be guided on

tasks they have not done before within the business. Always ask your manager questions and wait for their instructions on how to complete a task. If their instructions go against the handbook, contact the owner immediately.

- Employee retraining will be a regular group orientation that will take an entire day to cover. We will also convene emergency meetings based on the occurrence of a significant incident or safety related concern. Your participation will be mandatory unless otherwise told.
- Employees who actively avoid safety related training will soon be unemployed from this company.
- Please take time to engage in company stretching before work begins. A stretch of the day will be performed by one of the managers every day. Stretching will lower your daily risk of injury when done correctly. Please, do not over stretch or attempt to do more than your physical limit. Thank you!

**Safety Meetings:**

- We will hold a brief safety meeting at the beginning of every month to convene on previous or upcoming safety related concerns. Emergency meetings are held as needed, and employees are required to be present if requested.
- We will record each safety meeting via audio recorder and store the audio chronologically in the Safety Meetings folder on a computer.
- Safety meetings are important to the long-term success of the business and its community. Please take them seriously.

**Personal Protective Equipment:**

- Any employee working directly with dogs must wear eye protection that is ANSI Z-87 certified. Eye protection is not an option; employees who actively avoid eye protection are subject to termination of employment.
- Always wear PPE as described in the handbook, do not perform any tasks while not wearing the appropriate PPE. If you are unsure that a job requires PPE, simply ask a manager for clarification.

**Operating Tools and Machinery:**

- Never augment or remove safety related devices from any tool, machine, or vehicle provided to you. Always check that the safety related devices are present and working for whatever tool, machine, or vehicle provided to you. If you have any concerns related to safety, ask your manager for assistance.
- Do not attempt to fix any tool, machine, or vehicle while it is actively plugged-in or turned-on.
- Make sure to notify a manager when you are using tools, machines, or vehicles that are not actively assigned to you.
- Wear PPE when performing tasks with tools, machines, or vehicles when required. Inspect everything prior to use, and make sure your PPE is functioning properly.
- Always turn in PPE that is broken or needs repair, we will replace it for free.

**Barking and Noise:**

- Momentary barking and spurts of loud noise are tolerable for no more than 5 seconds. This rule applies during daycare hours to dogs. Any noise during daycare hours related to maintenance and construction is acceptable. Daycare

hours are from 7:30AM-10:30PM.

- Any loud noise or barking before 7:30AM and after 10:30PM is never acceptable inside or outside.
- Any dogs that are actively barking outside for more than 5-seconds must be taken inside. If the dog continues to bark inside, apply a leash to their collar and correct with a gentle pull and tell the dog to sit. If a gentle pull to the collar does not work, apply a firmer pull and ask to sit again. Pull the leash upwards in the direction of the dogs' butt; this will encourage and guide them to sit. Once the dog is paying attention to the leash and employee, correct the barking with the command to stop or no bark. After the dog listens without barking, praise them with plenty of affection and allow them to interact with other dogs again. You may have to repeat the previous steps multiple times before you see active result. If the dog does not listen after multiple attempts, kennel them in an isolation area and attempt to wait for them to calm down.
- If a dog does not listen to an employee after being properly guided many times, a manager must consider not allowing that dog in daycare and boarding. The dog may also need to be retrieved as soon as possible to maintain peace of mind at daycare. Dogs removed from daycare for excessive barking may be allowed back after proof of training by a professional.
- Maintaining a calm and quiet environment at daycare is mandatory for the peace of mind of surrounding neighbors. It must be a top priority for every manager, employee, and client.

**Dog Handling:**

- Do not handle dogs unless wearing ANSI Z-87 certified eye protection.
- Do not actively engage a dog while it is engaged by another employee. Unless the employee requests assistance, remain quiet as to not distract or intervene in the situation. This will help dogs avoid confusion.
- Always remember that physical presence and an approach towards dominance that promotes nurture will cause for a healthier and more symbiotic environment. Nervousness and callous behavior will cause stress and high anxiety not only within yourself but also within the dogs.
- No soft toys, especially fabric toys, at daycare. Chuck-It Balls are a relatively safe toy, and acceptable to use with dogs.
- When walking outside of the facility, all dogs must be double leashed on a lock nut carabiner. This means two points of contact from the carabiner. One cinching lead is put on first. Next put on any harness, choker, gentle leader, or collar; always put it on last. They are both attached to a carabiner that is attached to a leash. Always put the cincher on first! Never forget to use two points of contact!
- While walking dogs, only use residentials and stay safe streets. Do not ever use a main road or arterial other than to cross them. Try to cross main roads at designated crosswalks and intersections with active sensors and buttons to assist with crossing the road. Never allow a dog to walk close to a busy road under any circumstances, ever. For more information, refer to the handbook.
- Remember to have emergency scissors in the event of a major entanglement while walking. Scissors are necessary inside the daycare for emergency

entanglements as well.

- If dogs are aggressively attacking each other or an employee, use any and all forms of self-defense to protect everyone from the aggressor. Isolate the aggressor and attempt to corral them into a separate space. Do not actively engage the aggressor if they are already isolated to a space. Do not ever hesitate to use self-defense as needed. After an incident refer to the Injury/Bite Log and fill it out. Also fill out an Employee Injury/Illness Report or an Employee Workplace Safety and Harm Reduction Report as needed.
- Aggressive dogs must always be muzzled outside of daycare. Do not take an aggressive dogs muzzle off unless you are trained to work with that specific dog. Always ask for help when working with new dogs.

**Grooming:**

- Never make direct contact with a dog's skin while using sharp instruments for grooming. Always use tools like a comb between skin and sharp tools, to not cut a dog.
- While grooming, use swivel leads that will not tighten. Apply collars to dogs that are easy to remove. Attach the collar to a swivel lead and make sure it will not choke the dog. Always secure the lead before beginning to work.
- Do not leave dogs unattended for any period of time while grooming. Do not leave them unattended with grooming devices that could cause them injury. Please always be within close proximity of any dog that you are grooming.

**Weather Safety:**

- Employees will spend a lot of time outside. We strongly suggest talking with a manager about what proper attire matches the season.
- Any employee perceived to be improperly dressed for the daily weather will be referred to a manager for safety related concerns and guidance on proper attire.
- Weather-related safety is a huge part of working with dogs. Season changes and heat waves can have lasting impacts on health if not approached in a mindful way. Never hesitate to ask for assistance if you cannot afford or procure the correct attire for the current season. We will always help our employees afford the work-related equipment that is required.

**ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND RECEIPT OF ACCIDENT PREVENTION PROGRAM**

I hereby acknowledge receipt of the Accident Prevention Program of Fremont Dog Plaza. I understand and agree that it is my responsibility to read and comply with the policies in the program. I understand that failing to comply with the Accident Prevention

Program could result in injury or damage to myself or another person, place, or thing. Complying with the Accident Prevention Program is non-negotiable; the result of failing to comply includes removal from Fremont Dog Plaza and the vicinity of any of its related operations.

_____

Name in Print

_____

Signature

_____

Date Signed